

FCE I · UNIT 3 · GRAMMAR P33

Revision: past perfect simple and continuous

About 15 minutes. Do it in pencil, then check with your teacher.

Past perfect simple (had + past participle): a single action finished *before* another past moment: *I had just arrived when she walked in.*

Past perfect continuous (had been + -ing): how long a situation lasted before something happened, or an activity with a visible result: *Her eyes were red: she had been crying.*

1 Circle the correct form.

- Jordi (had just parked / had just been parking) his car when the singer came out.
- The queue (had been growing / had grown) for hours when the shop finally opened.
- Her hands were black with oil: she (had repaired / had been repairing) the bike all morning.
- Clara (had won / had been winning) the prize before she turned twenty.
- Eva was exhausted because she (had been training / had trained) in the heat of El Cabanyal since six o'clock.
- When I opened my bag, I realised I (had left / had been leaving) my phone on the Malvarrosa beach.

2 Complete with the past perfect simple or continuous.

- Rubén's voice was hoarse because he _____ (shout) at the match all afternoon.
- Raquel couldn't get in because she _____ (lose) her keys.
- Nuria's hands were covered in flour: she _____ (bake) all morning.
- Sergio had just _____ (sit) down when the band started to play.
- We were hungry because we _____ (not / have) lunch.
- Gemma was nervous because she _____ (never / take) an English exam before.

3 Each sentence has one mistake. Write the correct sentence.

1. The contestants had been live in the house for six months.

2. Tomás had been arrived at the station five minutes before the train left.

3. When we got to the Turia, it already started to rain.

4. I could see that he has been running because he was out of breath.

5. We had been wait in the queue for two hours when the doors opened.

4 True for you. Finish the sentences.

1. Before I came to class today, I had

2. When I woke up this morning, I had been
